

Jaipur Heritage Guide

JAI001: Amer Fort. Located high on a hill in Amer, just outside Jaipur, this magnificent fort was built in 1592 by Raja Man Singh I. Constructed of red sandstone and stunning marble, the fort is renowned for its artistic Hindu style elements. The complex consists of four main levels, each with a courtyard. The most famous structure inside is the Sheesh Mahal (Mirror Palace), whose walls and ceilings are covered with intricate mirrored mosaics that can be fully illuminated by a single candle. Amer Fort served as the main residence of the Rajput Maharajas before the capital moved to Jaipur.

JAI002: Hawa Mahal. Known as the 'Palace of Winds', the Hawa Mahal is an architectural marvel built in 1799 by Maharaja Sawai Pratap Singh. Designed by Lal Chand Ustad, the five-story exterior is shaped like the crown of Lord Krishna and features 953 small windows called jharokhas, decorated with intricate latticework. The primary purpose of this design was to allow royal ladies to observe everyday life and festivals in the street below without being seen, strictly following the rules of purdah. The honeycomb structure also created a Venturi effect, keeping the palace naturally air-conditioned during hot Rajputana summers.

JAI003: City Palace. Situated in the heart of Jaipur, the City Palace was established at the same time as the city of Jaipur by Maharaja Sawai Jai Singh II in 1727. It represents a spectacular fusion of Rajput, Mughal, and European architectural styles. The sprawling complex includes the Chandra Mahal, which continues to serve as the residence of the Jaipur royal family, and the Mubarak Mahal, which now operates as a museum displaying royal textiles, weapons, and artifacts. The palace is famous for its four meticulously decorated gates in the Pritam Niwas Chowk, each representing a different season and Hindu deity.

JAI004: Jantar Mantar. Built by the scholarly Rajput king Sawai Jai Singh II in 1734, the Jantar Mantar in Jaipur is a UNESCO World Heritage Site containing 19 architectural astronomical instruments. It features the world's largest stone sundial, the Vrihat Samrat Yantra, which can tell

the local time with an astonishing accuracy of two seconds. The instruments were designed using principles of ancient Hindu Sanskrit texts to observe astronomical positions with the naked eye. It represents the pinnacle of astronomical observation in medieval India and stands as a testament to the scientific advancement and architectural brilliance of the Rajput era.

JAI005: Albert Hall Museum. The oldest museum in Rajasthan, the Albert Hall Museum is a stunning example of Indo-Saracenic architecture. Designed by Sir Samuel Swinton Jacob, it was opened to the public in 1887. The building was originally intended to be a town hall but was converted into a museum by Maharaja Sawai Madho Singh II to showcase the art and culture of the region. The extensive collection includes rich artifacts such as ancient coins, marble art, pottery, carpets, and even an Egyptian mummy. The building's intricate corridors and murals are beautifully illuminated at night, becoming a major Jaipur landmark.